THE MARINE ENVIRONMENT PROTECTION COMMITTEE, BEING AWARE of the ecological, social, cult
ural, economic and scientific attributes of the south-west Coral Sea, as well as its vul
nerability to damage by international shipping activities and the steps taken by the Gov
ernment of Australia to address that vulnerability, NOTING the Revised guidelines for th
e Identification and Designation of Particularly Sensitive Sea Areas (PSSA Guidelines),
adopted by the Assembly by resolution A.982(24), and the Revised Guidance Document for s
ubmission of PSSA proposals to IMO (MEPC.1/Circ.510), RECALLING resolution MEPC.133(53),
by which the Torres Strait (TS) was designated as - Revised Guidance Document for submis
sion of PSSA proposals to IMO (MEPC.1/Circ.510), RECALLING resolution MEPC.133(53), by w
hich the Torres Strait (TS) was designated as an extension of the Great Barrier Reef (GB
R) Particularly Sensitive Sea Area (PSSA), HAVING CONSIDERED the proposal made by the Go
vernment of Australia to extend the GBR and TS PSSA to include the south-west part of th
e Coral Sea, HAVING AGREED, at its sixty-eighth session, that the criteria for the ident
ification and designation of a PSSA provided in resolution A.982(24) are fulfilled for t
he extension of the GBR and TS PSSA to include the south-west part of the Coral Sea, HAV
ING NOTED that the Sub-Committee on Navigation, Communications and Search and Rescue (NC
SR), at its second session, approved the establishment of two 5 nautical mile wide two-w
ay routes and a new area to